

White spot disease has been detected in NSW prawns. [Find out about the response to contain and eradicate the disease currently underway.](#)

Aquatic animals, like terrestrial animals and humans, can be affected by infectious diseases, which may be caused by pathogens such as:

- viruses
- bacteria
- fungi
- protozoa
- parasites

Infection and disease in aquatic animals is normal, but can become severe under certain conditions. These can include the introduction of new diseases to a population or conditions that promote disease, such as host animal stress.

Early identification of aquatic animal diseases is important and helps us protect:

- sustainability of commercial and recreational fisheries
- productivity of aquaculture industries
- access to international markets for Australian seafood industries
- aquatic environments

We lead the management of aquatic animal health in Australia.

Find out more about our [aquatic animal health programs](#) and our [emergency aquatic animal disease preparedness and response](#) activities.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/pests-diseases-weeds/aquatic>